Tony Stark isn't the only one improving the suits. The look of the Iron Man armors starts with the Visual Development Department at Marvel Studios, where artists digitally paint new designs. Some of these are based on Iron Man's long, rich history in Marvel comic books, while others are imagined for the movies. From there, the artwork is rendered to 3-D sculptures, then sent to Legacy Effects to be physically created.

"We have the luxury of doing multiple films in the series," Legacy Effects Supervisor Shane Mahan says. "Each time, we have the opportunity to correct and modify the structures, methods, and materials to create better suits."

